

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Shakil Rahman

Address: Blessings 3 Wotton Way Cheam, Sutton SM2 7LA

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:URGENT

To the
Sutton Council
Civic Officer
Saint Nicholas Way,
Sutton SM1 1EA

Ref: Attention of Ms Polly Davidson application reference 2020 501591

Dear Ms Davidson,

You may have received many letters in the support of the proposed community centre and proposed place of worship.

I would like to take the opportunity to introduce our selves.

So, who are we? We are ordinary people who live in the locality amongst our neighbours, in our community there are those who are working as civil servants, teachers, nurses, businessman, doctors self-employed, engineers and other allied healthcare workers etc, we contribute heavily to the welfare of local communities both intellectually and economically.

The difference be that we are practising Muslims as well. We are disciplined organise conscientious and highly committed group to support community and achieve cohesion.

The centre will offer us an opportunity not only to worship but at the same time engage with all in our neighbourhood in variety of ways.

To organise activities with the help of our dedicated volunteers, such as contemporary education, hold career guidance classes for our youngsters, in sectors such as business, accountancy, medicine etc. Additionally offer health education in health areas such as managing diabetes and common conditions like asthma via our locally employed health care workers.

As I mentioned earlier, we are very much aware of maintaining good relationships with our neighbours therefore we will have open days and invite wide sections of community for friendly open days, holding seminars work cohesively with the local church and clergy. To have tea and cakes evening, we have great Chefs in our volunteer groups that keeps us healthy and energised.

I write you with some experience myself of being in the leadership team. I have served NHS as a respiratory consultant at Epsom and St Helier University Hospitals for over 25years.

I have also been the chair of Epsom and Ewell Islamic Society, for over 10 years until, 2018, in this respect had the pleasure of working closely and collaboratively with Rev Preston at St Barnabas Church on Temple road and with the whole of the local community.

During these years we collaborated with not only all the local faith groups, but with Bishop of Guildford, held open days with our neighbours, lunch afternoons, tea, and cake evenings. Additionally enjoyed excellent relationships with the local MP Chris Grayling, the Mayor, and the counsellors.

I hope the establishment of this centre will allow us to develop similar community relationships with our council, MP, other faith groups and most importantly with the whole neighbourhood and act as a beacon not only for Sutton but for the rest of the country.

I sincerely hope that the council will not be influenced by the negativity which may have been spread around. We would in fact in good faith approach those with concerns and logically and sympathetically endeavour to address their views and offer a friendly dialogue with those who have a real concerns and it is perfectly understandable for some of the negative concerns raised and to have genuine fears and it is up to us to be able to have a constructive dialogue and allay their anxieties.

Once again thank you very much for all the help and support you are giving our community

My very best wishes.

Shakil

Professor and Dr Shakil Rahman
Consultant in Respiratory Medicine
Clinical Sub Dean Undergraduate Department
Site Director AUC School of Medicine
Lead for Trust Medical Audit
St George's, Epsom, and St Helier University Hospitals